# Alessandro Vozza

Site Reliability Engineer | Kubernetes, Service Mesh & API Platforms | Bare Metal to Cloud

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## SUMMARY

Infrastructure engineer with 20+ years treating operations as a software problem — from Linux system administration and OpenStack/Ceph private clouds, through large-scale Kubernetes and Istio service-mesh platforms, to a multi-cluster bare-metal Kubernetes estate I run in production today in a commercial Amsterdam datacenter. I have designed the API-gateway and service-mesh layer (Istio, Envoy, Gateway API) that fronts enterprise services, operated etcd, Ceph and CSI through live incidents, and built automation that removes hours of daily toil, including agent-based coding and operations pipelines. Golden Kubestronaut and CNCF Ambassador. I am hands-on, own what I ship, and want to break the link between system size and operational effort — which is the SRE mission.

## CORE TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

**Reliability & operations:** SLO/SLI design, incident response and post-incident review, capacity planning, toil reduction through automation, progressive delivery and rollback, GitOps change management, on-call for owned infrastructure

**Kubernetes:** Golden Kubestronaut (CKA, CKAD, CKS + CNCF suite); RKE2, Talos Linux, AKS, OpenShift/ARO, operators & CRDs, multi-cluster ArgoCD, Backstage

**Service mesh & API platforms:** Istio, Envoy, Gloo Mesh / Gloo Gateway, Gateway API, mTLS-by-default, service exposure, authentication and authorization at the edge, rate limiting/throttling, zero-trust network policy

**Bare metal & infrastructure:** Proxmox VE, Ceph (block/object), etcd operations, OpenStack, Linux (Debian/RHEL family), DNS/DHCP/NTP (PowerDNS, NetBox as source of truth, IPv6-first dual-stack), out-of-band management (iDRAC), Juniper switching/routing, GPU infrastructure

**Cloud:** Azure (Solution Architect, DevOps & Security Engineer Expert), AWS (Cloud Practitioner; EKS-equivalent patterns via Kubernetes portability), GCP (Professional Cloud Architect)

**Automation & code:** Python, Bash, Go (working knowledge), Terraform/Bicep, Ansible, GitHub Actions; daily use of agentic coding tools (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot) to deliver in whichever language the problem needs

**Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Datadog; alerting design, LLM/API endpoint benchmarking

## SELECTED RELIABILITY & PLATFORM WORK

**Production Multi-Cluster Bare-Metal Kubernetes** — co-located at NorthC, Amsterdam 2025–present

- Operate an 11-node Proxmox cluster with Ceph distributed storage backing RKE2 and Talos Linux Kubernetes clusters, running as a personal production estate.
- Handled live incidents end-to-end: etcd snapshot restoration on Talos, Ceph health degradation, CSI/storage failures — diagnosis, remediation, and hardening to prevent recurrence.
- Benchmarked LLM inference endpoints and planned GPU capacity for a 64× NVIDIA B300 cluster serving a commercial AI inference service.

**AI Datacenter Platform Build-out (AMS1)** — Dutch AI-infra startup (via Lovelace Eng.) 2026–present

- Designing and standing up the platform layer for a new GPU datacenter: Proxmox/Ceph foundation, Talos Kubernetes running NetBox, ArgoCD, Prometheus/Grafana/Loki and PowerDNS, with Juniper MX/SRX/QFX networking and Dell GPU nodes.
- Authored the DDI architecture decision record: IPv6-first dual-stack addressing, ASN-per-POD, NetBox as single source of truth, and out-of-band management design; chose DHCP relay over a separate Kea deployment to keep one authoritative source.
- Reviewed rack layouts, cabling and colo contract scope (8× 46U racks, ~173 kW) — the unglamorous groundwork that determines reliability later.

**Multi-Cluster Progressive Delivery** — enterprise client 2023

- Architected a zero-downtime deployment pipeline with ArgoCD, Gateway API and Istio across multiple clusters: 100% availability during deployments, automated rollback, and measurably higher release confidence.

**Agentic Automation Platform** — personal production system 2024–present

- Built and operate a multi-agent system on Anthropic's Claude API (Azure Container Apps, LiteLLM proxy, integrations with Slack, Discord, Telegram, WhatsApp) that owns routine workflows end-to-end — communications triage, research, code generation — removing 3–4 hours of manual toil per day.

**Internal Developer Platform for 15 Teams** — enterprise client 2023–2024

- Shipped a Backstage-based IDP with GitHub Actions, standardising delivery and service ownership across 15 teams: onboarding time down 60%, real-time visibility into deployment frequency and team health.

## EXPERIENCE

**Sr. Solution Engineer, Cloud + AI** — Microsoft 2025–2026 | Amsterdam

- Owned complex technical evaluations of AKS, Azure Container Apps and Azure AI Foundry for enterprise and public-sector accounts; architected regulated, production-grade workloads and advised platform teams on GPU infrastructure, compliance (DORA, EU AI Act) and OpenShift-on-Azure patterns.

**Independent Consultant Architect** — Lovelace Engineering B.V. 2018–present | Amsterdam

- Energy (oil & gas): Azure landing-zone and AKS platform architecture for a global migration — network segmentation, identity, policy-as-code guardrails for multi-region workloads.
- Banking: secure, regulator-ready cloud-native platform on AKS with Istio mTLS-by-default, GitOps delivery and zero-trust network policy.
- Insurance: led ArgoCD GitOps adoption across a multi-cluster Kubernetes estate, moving delivery teams to self-service, auditable deployments.

**Founder & CEO** — Kubespaces.io 2024–present | Amsterdam

- Built a Kubernetes namespaces-as-a-service product: self-service ephemeral and production namespaces with quota, network policy and RBAC guardrails by default; owned the control plane for environment lifecycle (create, suspend, destroy).

**Senior Platform Advocate** — Solo.io 2022–2024 | Remote / Amsterdam

- Led technical evangelism and hands-on enablement for Istio-based Gloo Mesh and Gloo Gateway (Envoy API gateway): multi-cluster mesh, Gateway API, edge authentication, rate limiting and zero-trust architecture for enterprise platform teams worldwide.

**Principal Software Engineer / Cloud Solution Arch.** — MicrosoftNov 2016–Dec 2022 | Amsterdam

- Delivered AKS readiness, deployment and DevOps engagements — cluster architecture, CI/CD, security baselines, production operations — for financial-services and public-sector customers; authored Kubernetes troubleshooting, auditing and security guidance shared at KubeCon.

**Freelance Cloud Native Architect** 2014–2016 | Amsterdam

- Designed and operated on-prem OpenStack, Ceph and OpenShift private clouds — compute, network and block/object storage — for European enterprises.

**Principal Architect, OpenStack & OpenShift** — Red Hat 2012–2014 | Amsterdam

- Led OpenStack and OpenShift deployments across EMEA, defining compute, network and Ceph/Swift storage architecture and private-cloud operating models.

**Certified Instructor** — Linux Foundation 2018–present

- Delivered CKA, CKAD and CKS training internationally to hundreds of engineers.

## CERTIFICATIONS

Golden Kubestronaut (Linux Foundation) · Azure Solution Architect Expert · Azure DevOps Engineer Expert · Azure Security Engineer · Google Professional Cloud Architect · AWS Cloud Practitioner · GitHub Copilot Certified · Microsoft Certified Trainer · Green Software Foundation Champion

## COMMUNITY & SPEAKING

CNCF Ambassador · Co-organiser, Cloud Native Community Days Amsterdam (since 2019) · Organiser, Cloud Native Rejekts EU 2026 · Speaker at KubeCon + CloudNativeCon and regional cloud-native meetups

## EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Ph.D. Chemistry — University of Amsterdam, 2004–2008

Italian (native) · English (fluent) · Dutch (professional) · Modern Greek (learning)